

TidyTuesday Week 32

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the only newsletter brave enough to shove two completely unrelated economic time series into a blender and describe what comes out as “research.” This week the random number gods handed us a truly inspired pairing: Coinbase Bitcoin, the digital asset that has personally ruined several dinner conversations, versus the San Francisco Tech Pulse index – which, and I cannot stress this enough, has been DISCONTINUED since March 2020. So yes, we are correlating a live cryptocurrency against a series that has been resting in peace for over six years. Naturally, this is where science happens.

The raw regression came out swinging with an R-squared of about 0.70, which in the language of overexcited spreadsheet enthusiasts means “oh my god, we found something.” Seventy percent! A p-value with more zeros than a crypto whale's wallet! If you stopped reading here, you might conclude that Bitcoin's price and a defunct San Francisco tech vibe-o-meter are practically soulmates. And you would be gloriously, hilariously wrong, because this is exactly the kind of trend-mirage this whole project exists to point and laugh at: two things that both drifted upward for years will happily hold hands in a raw regression whether or not they've ever actually met.

Enter the detrended version, the great humbler. Once we strip out each series' own long-run drift, that majestic 0.70 R-squared faceplants down to a deeply humble 0.14. The relationship doesn't vanish entirely – it's technically still “significant” at the p-around-0.003 level, which I suppose earns it a participation trophy – but going from explaining 70 percent of the wiggle to explaining 14 percent is the statistical equivalent of a superhero who loses his powers the moment the cameras show up. So most of that dazzling raw fit was just two lines going up together and taking credit for teamwork.

As always, the mandatory reminder for anyone tempted to build a trading strategy or a thesis around this: these are RANDOMLY paired series, there is no causal story, no rigorous claim, and absolutely no reason Bitcoin should care about a discontinued Bay Area index that stopped updating around the time we all learned to bake sourdough. Spurious correlation isn't the bug here, it's the entire premise. Tune in next week when we heroically torture two more innocent datasets that never asked to be in the same graph.

2 Date: 2026-08-03

Series ID: CBBTCUSD

This series is titled Coinbase Bitcoin and has a frequency of Daily, 7-Day. The units are U.S. Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2014-12-01 and the observation end date is 2026-08-02. The popularity of this series is 75.

Series ID: SFTPINDM114SFRBSF

This series is titled San Francisco Tech Pulse (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index Jan 2000=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1971-04-01 and the observation end date is 2020-03-01. The popularity of this series is 10.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_SFTPINDM114SFRBSF	R-squared:	0.695
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.690
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	139.1
Date:	Mon, 03 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	2.21e-17
Time:	14:09:51	Log-Likelihood:	-185.92
No. Observations:	63	AIC:	375.8
Df Residuals:	61	BIC:	380.1
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	84.9060	0.863	98.348	0.000	83.180	86.632
value_fred_CBBTCUSD	0.0018	0.000	11.796	0.000	0.002	0.002

Omnibus:	9.975	Durbin-Watson:	0.305
Prob(Omnibus):	0.007	Jarque-Bera (JB):	10.825
Skew:	0.715	Prob(JB):	0.00446
Kurtosis:	4.442	Cond. No.	8.11e+03

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 8.11e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

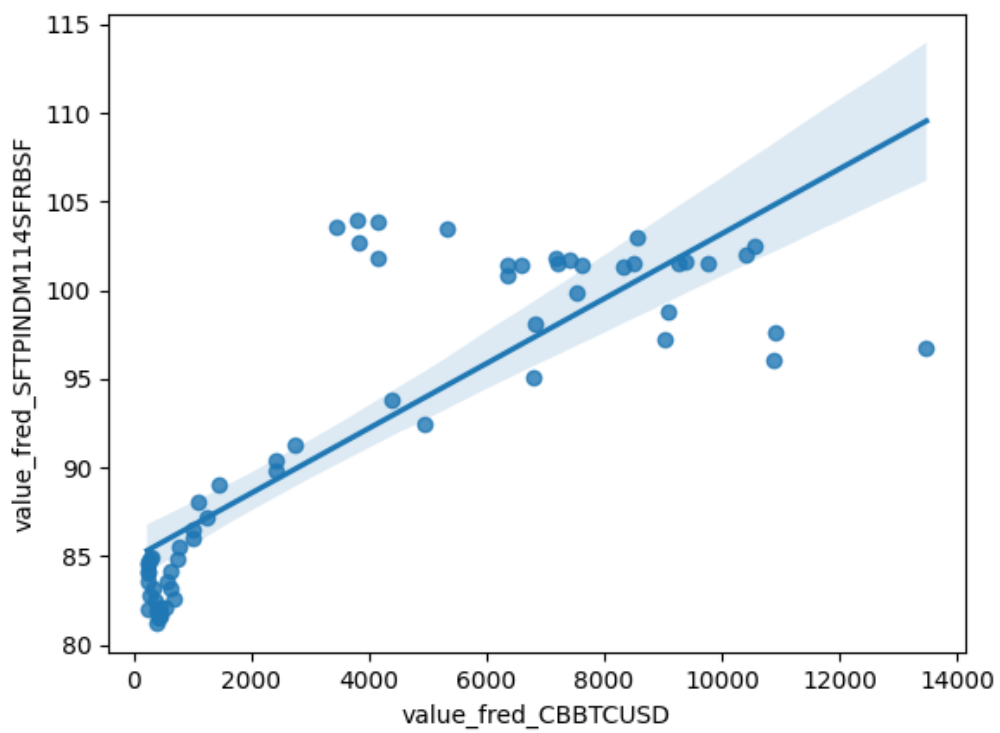


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-03

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_SFTPINDM114SFRBSF_detrended	R-squared:	0.137
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.123
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	9.672
Date:	Mon, 03 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.00284
Time:	14:09:51	Log-Likelihood:	-150.74
No. Observations:	63	AIC:	305.5
Df Residuals:	61	BIC:	309.8
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	3.857e-12	0.339	1.14e-11	1.000	-0.678	0.678
value_fred_CBBTCUSD_detrended	0.0005	0.000	3.110	0.003	0.000	0.001

Omnibus:	23.048	Durbin-Watson:	0.095
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	4.918
Skew:	0.258	Prob(JB):	0.0855
Kurtosis:	1.732	Cond. No.	2.25e+03

Notes:

- [1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.
- [2] The condition number is large, 2.25e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

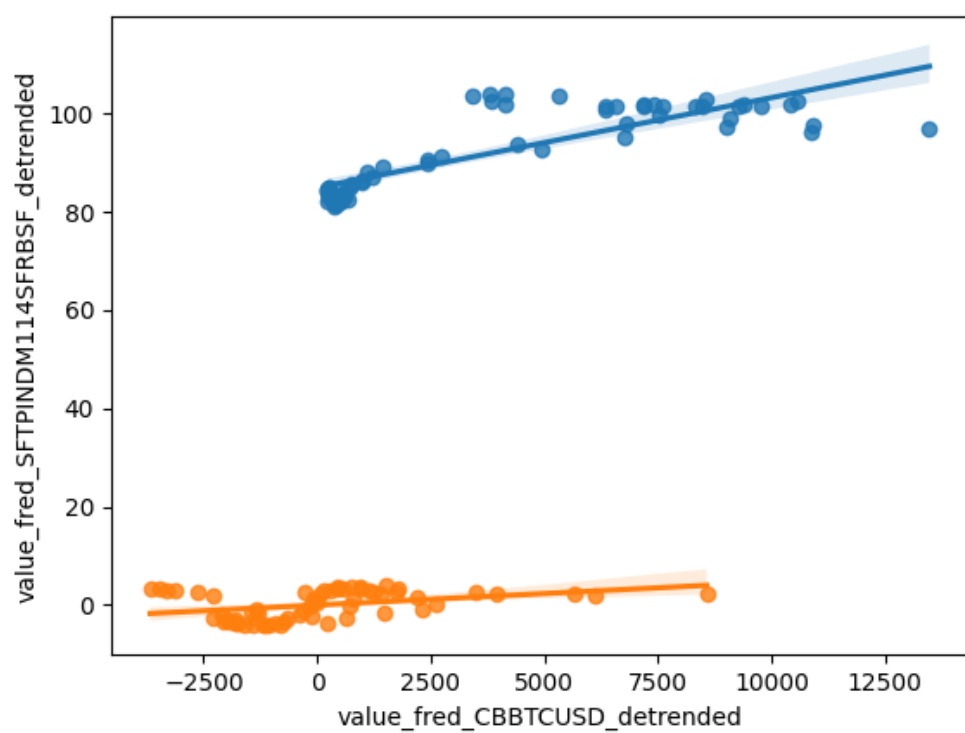


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-03